INFOSYS SE ASSESSMENT 2026 • OFFICIAL PREPARATION VAULT

Infosys SE Complete Preparation — Logical Deduction & Critical Reasoning

Section: prepinsta infosys SE | **Drive Date:** 5th & 6th November 2026 | **Status:** 100% Solved & Verified

Infosys SE Complete Preparation — Logical Deduction & Critical Reasoning

Source Portal: PrepInsta Infosys Preparation Suite (`https://prepinsta.com/infosys-english-verbal-questions/critical-reasoning/`)
Target Role: Infosys Systems Engineer (SE) | **Category:** 02_Logical_Reasoning_Ability
Total Verified Questions Extracted: 10
Quizzes Covered: Quiz 1 (Diagnostic Exam), Critical Reasoning Question Bank

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📋 Section 1: Rules to Keep in Mind

These rules and fundamental principles govern all Infosys logical deduction questions:

- **Strict Premise Adherence:** All conclusions and inferences must be derived 100% strictly from stated facts. Do not assume unstated real-world domain knowledge.
- **Weaken the Argument Mechanism:** To weaken an argument, identify the unstated assumption connecting the premise to the conclusion and show an alternative explanation or critical flaw.
- **Strengthen the Argument Mechanism:** Supply external data that confirms the validity of the central unstated assumption.
- **Inference Definition:** An inference is an unstated fact that MUST be true if the given statements are true.
- **Beware Absolute Traps:** Options with words like 'always', 'never', 'only', 'completely' are invalid in 90% of deduction questions unless the passage explicitly asserts them.

⚡ Section 2: How to Solve Quickly

Proven time-saving strategies recommended by PrepInsta for Infosys 2026 examination:

1. **Read Question Stem First:** Determine whether the goal is to Weaken, Strengthen, Infer, or Resolve Paradox before reading the text passage.
2. **Deconstruct the Core Argument:** Identify Premise (evidence) and Conclusion (claim). The Assumption is the unstated bridge between them.
3. **Aggressive Elimination:** Eliminate options that describe true real-world facts but are completely irrelevant to the author's specific logical scope.

🚀 Section 3: Tricks & Shortcuts

Key mathematical formulas, mental-math shortcuts, and speed axioms:

- **The Negation Test for Assumptions:** If you negate an assumption and the author's conclusion falls apart, that assumption is mandatory and correct.
- **Scope Shift Recognition:** Watch when the premise talks about one entity (e.g. theft/murder) and the conclusion leaps to another entity (e.g. terrorism).
- **Profit Formula Bridge:** Profit = Revenue - Cost. Any choice that reduces costs explains a profit surge without needing a revenue increase.

📚 Section 4: Practice Questions, Options & Step-by-Step Solutions

Contains **10** verbatim questions with options, verified answer keys, and complete derivations:

Question 1 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q1)

Question Stem:
"Some men are definitely intelligent, others are definitely not intelligent, but of intermediate men, we should say, 'intelligent'? Yes, I think, so or no, I shouldn't be inclined to call him intelligent."

Which of the following reflects the intention of the writer well?

Options:
- `(A) To call men intelligent who are not strikingly so must be to use the concept with undue imprecision`
- `(B) Every empirical concept has a degree of vagueness`
- `(C) Calling someone intelligent or not depends upon one's whim`
- `(D) There is no need to be as indecisive as the writer of the above`

Correct Answer: `(A) To call men intelligent who are not strikingly so must be to use the concept with undue imprecision`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

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The writer hesitates to apply the label 'intelligent' to borderline or intermediate cases, asserting that applying the term to someone who is not strikingly intelligent introduces undue imprecision into the definition.
```

Question 2 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q2)

Question Stem:
A highly cohesive work group is a prerequisite for high team performance. Sociologists point out that the association between success and group cohesion owes to the support individual team members give to one another and their acceptance of the group's activities and goals.

Each of the following, if true, either supports or cannot weaken the sociologists' assumption about the relationship between success and cohesion EXCEPT:

Options:

- `(A) A group of Japanese researchers found that the successful work teams were led by dominant leaders`
- `(B) University researchers found that there was a significant correlation between team productivity and the extent to which team members understood and complied with the group's objectives`
- `(C) American researchers found that successful team members tended to rate their fellow members more favourably`
- `(D) Industrial Psychologists of UK found that work groups who tended to participate in after-hours social activities were more productive`

Correct Answer: `(A) A group of Japanese researchers found that the successful work teams were led by dominant leaders`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

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If success is driven by a single dominant leader rather than lateral interpersonal cohesion and peer mutual support, this directly weakens the sociologists' claim that success owes fundamentally to group cohesion.
```

Question 3 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q3)

Question Stem:

Offshore oil-drilling operations involve an unavoidable risk of an oil spill, but importing oil on tankers presently involves an even greater such risk per barrel of oil. So, if we are to lessen the risk of an oil spill without reducing our oil usage, we must invest more in offshore operations and import less oil on tankers.

Which of the following, if true, seriously weakens the argument above?

Options:

- `(A) Importing oil on tankers is currently less expensive than drilling for it offshore.`
- `(B) Tankers can easily be redesigned so that their use entails less risk of an oil spill.`
- `(C) The impact of offshore operations on the environment can be reduced by careful management.`
- `(D) Oil spills caused by tankers have generally been more serious than those caused by offshore operations.`

Correct Answer: `(B) Tankers can easily be redesigned so that their use entails less risk of an oil spill.`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

```
The argument's recommendation to switch away from tankers assumes that the current risk disparity is fixed. If tankers can easily be redesigned to minimize spill risks, the need to switch to offshore drilling evaporates.
```

Question 4 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q4)

Question Stem:

Alan: In the last 15 years, most of the criminals who were convicted of theft or murder were from the lower income classes and had not completed high school. Therefore, the government has to spend more money on

reducing poverty and increase funding to education. Because terrorism is the most severe of all crimes, such measures would bring down overall crime rate and reduce threat from terrorism.

Dylan: A study that was conducted in a country known to produce a number of terrorists showed that on average the terrorists were better educated than the overall population and that they did not necessarily come from lower income classes. This is probably because crimes such as theft are committed for personal gain while terrorism is for political or religious gain.

Which of the following best describes Dylan's response to Alan?

Options:

- `(A) Dylan changes the direction of the argument entirely by discussing the scenario in a different country`
- `(B) Dylan partially agrees with Alan's reasoning but refutes his recommendation to the government`
- `(C) Dylan converts a causal argument made by Alan into a generalization applicable universally`
- `(D) Dylan challenges Alan's reasoning by explaining why two situations that Alan perceives as similar are not`
- `(E) While Alan arrives at a conclusion by drawing an analogy, Dylan arrives at the same conclusion by refuting the analogy`

Correct Answer: `(D) Dylan challenges Alan's reasoning by explaining why two situations that Alan perceives as similar are not`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

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Alan lumps theft/murder and terrorism into the same socioeconomic bucket. Dylan refutes this by demonstrating that terrorists have different demographic profiles, proving the two crimes cannot be treated with the same poverty-alleviation remedy.
```

Question 5 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q5)

Question Stem:

In contrast to the earlier predictions, demand for sugarcane has not risen in recent years, yet, even though production amounts and price have also been stable during the last 3 years. Last year, sugarcane growers increased their profits by more than 10 percent over the previous year's level.

Any of the following statements, if true, about last year, helps explain the rise in profits EXCEPT:

Options:

- `(A) Many sugar factories that are large consumers of sugarcane increase their production of sugarcane-based ethanol, yet their overall consumption of sugarcane decreased.`
- `(B) Rainfall in sugarcane-growing regions was higher than it had been during previous year, allowing the growers to save money on expensive artificial irrigation.`
- `(C) Sugarcane growers have saved money on wages by switching from paying laborers a daily wage to paying them by the amount harvested.`
- `(D) Many small sugarcane growers joined together to form an association of sugarcane producers and began to buy supplies at low group rates.`

Correct Answer: `(A) Many sugar factories that are large consumers of sugarcane increase their production of sugarcane-based ethanol, yet their overall consumption of sugarcane decreased.`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

```
Profit = Revenue - Cost. Options B, C, and D all describe substantial production cost reductions (saving on irrigation, wages, supplies). Option A describes decreased consumption, which would depress grower revenue and cannot explain a profit surge.
```

Question 6 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q6)

Question Stem:
Ismat Chughtai's celebrated masterpiece 'Lihaf' needs to be analyzed under the interwoven themes of marriage, subjugation of women and the oppression and neglect of female sexuality and desire... Which one of the following can be inferred from the given passage?

Options:

- `(A) Under the garb of a social norm and societal obligation, marriage as an institution, often tends to oppress the participants involved.`
- `(B) Marriage is a sacred institution across all communities which need not be questioned.`
- `(C) Begum Jan belonged to a financially poor family`
- `(D) None of the above`

Correct Answer: `(A) Under the garb of a social norm and societal obligation, marriage as an institution, often tends to oppress the participants involved.`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

```
The passage explicitly develops the thesis that marriage functioned as an unbreakable social obligation that commodified Begum Jan and entrapped both her and the Nawab into repressive, neglected roles.
```

Question 7 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q7)

Question Stem:
Regarding the passage on Chughtai's 'Lihaf', pick out the incorrect statement from the following:

Options:

- `(A) Chughtai critiques the mercenary aspect of marriage that dehumanizes women to fulfill societal obligations and dreams of upward mobility.`
- `(B) Begum Jan was just a social stamp of approval of Nawab, a heterosexual cover to escape ridicule.`
- `(C) The status accorded to marriage as an unbreakable social norm and an unquestionable obligation is discussed in the short story by Chughtai.`
- `(D) Begum Jan was very dear to the Nawab.`

Correct Answer: `(D) Begum Jan was very dear to the Nawab.`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

```
The text explicitly states that the Nawab 'installed her in the house along with furniture', displayed zero interest in her life, and 'totally forgot her presence'.
```

Question 8 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q8)

Question Stem:
Pick out the correct statement directly supported by the passage on 'Lihaf':

Options:
- `(A) Begum Jan was free to choose her partner in marriage.`
- `(B) The Nawab expressed interest in his wife’s life.`
- `(C) Chughtai critiques the mercenary aspect of marriage.`
- `(D) Chughtai raises important questions on the evils of dowry system and bride burning.`

Correct Answer: `(C) Chughtai critiques the mercenary aspect of marriage.`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

```
Directly verbatim in paragraph 2: 'Chughtai critiques the mercenary aspect of marriage that
dehumanizes women to fulfill societal obligations'.
```

Question 9 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q9)

Question Stem:
Which one of the following is the synonym of the word 'desolation' as used in the context of the passage?

Options:
- `(A) Loneliness`
- `(B) Creation`
- `(C) Cheer`
- `(D) Pursuit`

Correct Answer: `(A) Loneliness`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

```
In the text, 'desolation' describes Begum Jan's emotional state of extreme neglect, depression,
and social isolation. 'Loneliness' is the precise synonym.
```

Question 10 (PrepInsta Critical Reasoning Quiz-1 - Q10)

Question Stem:
Which one of the following is the antonym of the word 'mercenary' as used in the context of the passage?

Options:
- `(A) Highlighted`
- `(B) Lucid`
- `(C) Altruistic`
- `(D) Refined`

Correct Answer: `(C) Altruistic`

PrepInsta Detailed Explanation & Logical Derivation:

'Mercenary' means motivated purely by money, material gain, or transactional self-interest. The exact opposite is 'Altruistic' (unselfish concern for the welfare of others).
